

Kaitlin Albey

Mobile Web Design

Brief overview and Description

The Impressionism site is created to give users a brief look into the impressionist artists and then give a navigation site so you could explore more if there is more information you would like to see about the artists. The target audience is for two specific people. Those who want a brief introduction to impressionism and those who want to know where the best places to see this art in person.

I chose 3 specific people for my feedback, Person A who has dyslexia, Person B who does not have the best eyesight, and Person C who is an art historian. Person A and B both had similar comments to the size and font of my original design. There were some Person A liked better, and some people B liked better, but in the end I chose a previous font I used, open sans, which they agreed was easier to read and I increased the size of my text. I did keep the cursive Impressionism at the top because it fit the style of the overall page, but that is why I added the bit “Impressionism” in black for accessibility for those who can not read the cursive

Then there was person C. They suggested I added more information to the actual artist cards on the main site as well as making them semi translucent. I adapted both these things, however I did very little translucency. You can see a touch of the paintings underneath, but if I did too much it would often be hard to even look at the words.

Code Explanation

Starting off with the checklist and HTML validation, I used the Schema microdata we used in the Resume project so I used that validator. At first there were a few errors, but I was able to use the chatbox in github to debug it. I would say my design is visually consistent, majority of my code was copy and paste in the html because all the cards needed to look the same and besides the Impressionism at the top, all of my code typography was consistent. I specifically chose a darker background in the gallery/museum html so the artwork would pop. For the transitioning background, to keep it consistent and moving smoothly I gave each of the artist-sections its own fixed background so it would change whenever you scroll and then used min-height and a gradient to make the transition seamless.. I later added in JS to make it look like each section fades in and out but I wanted to make sure it would still work without js. The breakouts that I used for the mobile, tablet, and desktop did not have much change between them besides the columns in which everything is displayed. The mobile has a single column of the images stack on top of the text, the tablet mainly adjusted typography and disabled the fixed background for performance, and the desktop used a larger hero text for more of an impact and better spacing. As I mentioned earlier I added in the fade in and out java script enhancements to make the background smoother for the progressive enhancement, but the code will still work without it. For Image optimization I used code like the `loading="lazy"` to improve performance and decoding `"async"` for rendering which was needed, especially seeing as the backgrounds are

images. I also added responsive images into the gallery/museum tab for that requirement. All Css should be separated from the html, I had started combining the two, but used the chatbox to make sure I didn't miss anything when I separated it out. I made a palette Favicon using a free site and I did have difficulties embedding it so I had to resort to adding it in to the chat box so it could add in the Favicon properly. And lastly as mentioned I added in the Microdate with the Schema.org/person.

Course Takeaways

This course introduced me to the core principles of modern mobile web development and how websites are built to function across a wide range of devices and browsers. One of the most important concepts I learned was the mobile first design approach, where layouts are designed initially for small screens and then progressively enhanced for larger devices using media queries. This changed how I think about structuring websites, shifting my focus from desktop design to responsive scalability from the start.

I also gained strong foundational skills in semantic HTML5. Another key area of learning was CSS layout systems, especially Grid. These tools allowed me to build responsive layouts without relying on outdated methods like floats. I remember learning flexbox in an earlier class so it was nice to refresh on those concepts. The course also introduced responsive images and media optimization, which I was particularly interested in. I have always found I like the

interactive and visual aspect of web development and coding as a whole. In addition, I learned how to implement JavaScript as an additive and not the main function, I had previously used javascript to do a lot of animations but I had never considered the possibility of what would happen if it didn't work.

Personally what I would like to investigate further would be more ways to use CSS to make animations and rely less on javascript. At the same time I would like to learn more javascript because I am interested in more interactive qualities in my websites rather than just scrolling and highlighting. My ideas for improvement are less to do with what I just mentioned and more with my work practice. I found myself, while understanding the concepts and code, having a hard time actually writing out the code in a correct and clean order which had caused me to rely on AI tools to help organize my code to be readable to others. I would like to work on my practices in creating code others can read and view without the need of AI tools to make my code readable.